

Java Expense Tracker – Interview Guide

1. 2-Minute Project Explanation

“My Java Expense Tracker is a console-based application that helps users manage daily expenses. Users can add expenses with amount, category, description, and date. The project uses OOP, where each expense is an object. An ArrayList stores expenses, and an ExpenseManager class handles operations like adding, deleting, viewing, and calculating totals by month or category.”

2. Problem Solved

Helps users track spending patterns and manage expenses efficiently.

3. Tech Stack

- Java
- ArrayList for dynamic expense storage
- HashMap for category/month summaries
- Scanner for input
- Classes/methods for clean structure

4. Project Architecture

- Expense.java: Model class
- ExpenseManager.java: Business logic
- Main.java: User interaction/menu

5. Challenges Faced

- Handling multiple expenses
- Creating clean logic separation
- Input validation
- Monthly & category calculations

6. Solutions

- Used ArrayList and LocalDate

- Separate classes and methods
- Modular design
- Testing with sample inputs

7. Future Enhancements

- File storage
- SQLite database
- Edit/update feature
- JavaFX GUI
- Export to CSV

8. Learnings

- Java OOP
- Collections
- Modular design
- Menu-driven applications